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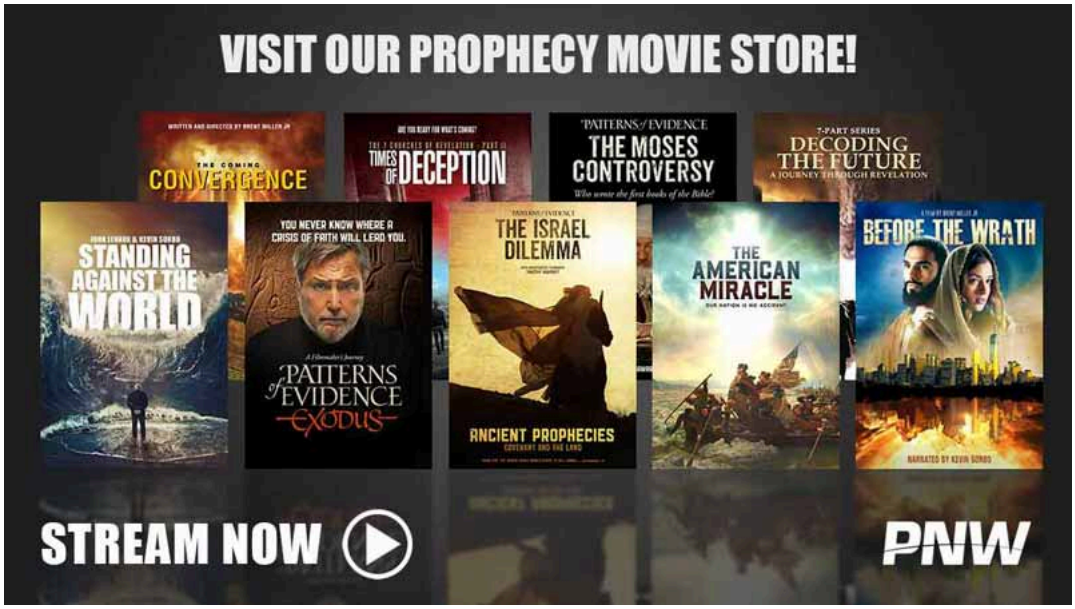

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ARTICLE

The NBA Reminds Christians That Taking A Stand Will Cost You Something

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BY PNW STAFF APRIL 02, 2026

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There was a time when Christians in America were told they were imagining things.

No one is targeting your faith, they said. No one is trying to silence biblical truth. No one is punishing believers for simply standing on what Scripture teaches.

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Then a story like Jaden Ivey's comes along--and the mask slips.

The Chicago Bulls did not waive Jaden Ivey because he committed a crime. He was not arrested. He was not accused of violence. He was not cut for some drunken scandal, sexual misconduct, or disgraceful off-court behavior that so often gets excused in professional sports. He was waived after publicly speaking about his Christian faith and criticizing the NBA's Pride activism.

And that should send a chill through every believer in America.

Because what happened to Ivey is not really about basketball. It is about the growing cost of speaking biblical truth in a culture that claims to celebrate diversity--unless that diversity includes Christians who still believe the Bible means what it says.

And now the fallout could be spreading to other sports as some NFL fans are calling for the Patriots to release running back TreVeyon Henderson for showing his support to Jaden Ivy after this incident. Instead of defending his player's right to free speech, Patriots head coach Mike Vrabel threw Treyveon under the woke bus by suggesting that Henderson needs to be inclusive and get educated.

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The Culture Still Tolerates "Christianity"--As Long As It Stays Vague

Let's be honest about what America still permits.

You can wear a cross necklace.

You can thank God after a game.

You can post a Bible verse if it is vague enough and doesn't offend the spirit of the age.

That kind of Christianity is still tolerated.

But the second a believer moves beyond generic spirituality and begins speaking clearly about sin, repentance, righteousness, and the Lordship of Jesus Christ, everything changes.

That is when the room turns cold.

Because the problem was never "faith." The problem is biblical clarity.

The world does not mind a Christian who is inspirational. It cannot stand a Christian who is specific.

And that is why this story matters.

Jaden Ivey did not simply say he loves Jesus. He reportedly challenged why the NBA promotes Pride messaging while treating biblical morality like a problem. In other words, he did what faithful Christians have done for 2,000 years: he measured culture against God's Word--and culture did not like the verdict.

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Because if "conduct detrimental to the team" is now grounds for getting cut, then Christians have every right to ask a simple question:

Where has that standard been for players involved in actual disgraceful behavior?

Professional sports has shown again and again that there is often room for players tied to assault allegations, domestic violence, sexual scandal, reckless behavior, and public moral collapse. Time after time, we are told these men deserve support, second chances, grace, and understanding.

And to be clear--Christians believe in redemption.

But here is the hypocrisy: the modern sports world seems to have categories for mercy when it comes to vice, but almost none when it comes to biblical conviction.

A man can bring shame to women, dishonor his family, and wreck his own reputation--and still find a path back.

But speak publicly about Jesus, sin, and sexual morality?

That, apparently, is where the line is now drawn.

That is not moral consistency.

That is cultural corruption.

If a Muslim Athlete Said the Same Thing, Would They React This Way?

And here is the question almost nobody in mainstream sports media will ask honestly:

What would happen if a Muslim athlete publicly quoted the Quran in similar moral terms?

What if he said his faith teaches that homosexual behavior is sinful?
What if he criticized a Pride-themed event on religious grounds?
What if he said his beliefs do not allow him to celebrate that message?

Would the sports world react the same way?

Would the media instantly portray him as dangerous?
Would coaches imply he needed help?
Would analysts suggest he was mentally spiraling?

Or would we suddenly hear words like "religious sensitivity," "cultural understanding," and "respect for deeply held beliefs"?

We all know the answer.

Because in modern elite culture, Christianity is the one faith they feel especially safe mocking, punishing, and pathologizing.

Now Biblical Christianity Is Being Treated Like a Mental Health Problem

And perhaps the darkest part of this entire story is how quickly the conversation shifted from disagreement to diagnosis.

Instead of simply saying, "We disagree with his views," the reaction from many corners has carried a far more sinister implication: that anyone who speaks this boldly about biblical truth must somehow be unstable, unwell, or in need of help.

That should deeply concern every Christian.

Because once biblical conviction is reframed as a mental health issue, it no longer has to be debated. It only has to be managed.

And that is exactly where much of the modern Left is heading.

They no longer just say Christians are wrong.

Now they increasingly imply Christians are psychologically defective for refusing to affirm LGBT ideology.

That is not tolerance.

That is not compassion.

That is ideological control wearing the language of therapy.

Today, if you reject Pride ideology, you are not "convicted"--you are "concerning."

If you preach repentance, you are not "faithful"--you are "spiraling."

If you say Jesus is the only way, you are not standing on truth--you are suddenly a "problem."

The old strategy was to call Christians hateful.

The new strategy is to call them mentally unwell.

And that should alarm the church.

This Is What Soft Persecution Looks Like

Some Christians still hesitate to use the word persecution in America.

They imagine persecution only as prison cells and martyrdom.

But persecution often begins long before that.

It begins when biblical truth becomes professionally dangerous.

It begins when Christians are told they are free to worship--so long as they do not publicly oppose the idols of the age.

It begins when believers are taught to whisper what God has said plainly.

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You may be a Christian.

You may even talk about faith.

But if you dare speak with biblical clarity on the moral issues the culture has declared untouchable, you may pay for it.

That is not freedom.

That is pressure.

And the church needs to stop pretending otherwise.

The Church Must Decide Whether It Wants Comfort or Courage

That is why the Jaden Ivey story matters.

Because this is no longer just about one athlete.

It is about whether Christians in America are willing to remain faithful when faithfulness begins to cost something.

The church now faces a choice.

We can keep sanding down the sharp edges of Scripture to remain culturally acceptable.

Or we can tell the truth in love and accept that the world will hate us for it.

One road leads to comfort.

The other leads to courage.

Only one of them leads to faithfulness.

And maybe that is what God is exposing in this hour.

Not just the hostility of the culture--but the weakness of a church that has grown too comfortable being liked.

Because faith is not proven when it is safe.

Faith is proven when truth becomes expensive--and you still refuse to be silent.

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